Sterile Technique & Theatre Setup

Study notes — Prevention of Nosocomial Infection unit. Personal condensed notes on asepsis, theatre setup, and the scrub/gown/glove sequence.

Core principles of asepsis

- Only sterile items touch the sterile field — any doubt means it's treated as contaminated
- Sterile fields are only sterile at table height and above eye level of the scrub team
- Movement around a sterile field stays sterile-to-sterile, non-sterile-to-non-sterile
- Sterile packs are opened and checked for integrity, expiry, and indicator colour change before use

Pre-operative theatre setup

- Theatre surfaces damp-dusted and checked before setup begins
- Operating table and positioning aids in place and functioning
- Instrument trolley draped and instruments laid in order of use
- Suction, diathermy, and lighting tested before the patient arrives
- Correct instrument set confirmed against the planned procedure

Scrub, gown, and glove sequence

- Surgical hand scrub timed and completed to protocol
- Gown donned without touching the outer sterile surface
- Gloves applied using closed-glove technique where trained to do so
- Second pair of gloves considered for high-risk procedures

Post-procedure basics

- Instruments accounted for against the opening count before closure
- Sharps disposed of immediately into a sharps container
- Instruments pre-cleaned before transfer to CSSD for sterilization
- Theatre turned over and re-checked before the next case

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